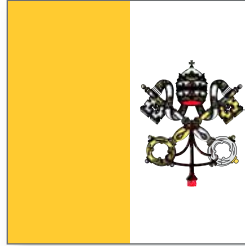


Vatican City

Ratio: 1:1 **Adopted:** June 7, 1929 **Usage:** Civil

Yellow (gold) and white (iron) are the colours of St Peter's keys

Yellow and white were adopted as the papal colours in 1808



The emblem features St. Peter's keys supporting the papal crown

Europe



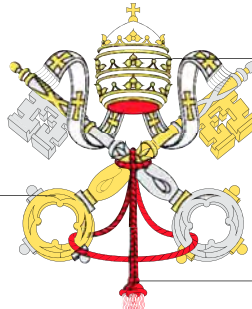
Vatican City, the Holy See of the Roman Catholic Church, is the smallest independent state in the world.

The modern Vatican colors were first adopted as the papal colors in 1808. The flag was used until 1870 when the Papal States were incorporated into a new unified Italy. In 1929, the Papal States were granted independent status, but their authority was confined to Vatican City. Gold and iron, represented in

the flag as yellow and white, are the colors of the keys of St. Peter, which have accompanied papal arms since the Middle Ages. The flag's white stripe bears an emblem used since the 13th century to represent the Vatican's role as the headquarters of the Roman Catholic Church.

EMBLEM OF VATICAN CITY

The crossed keys represent the keys to the Kingdom of Heaven bestowed by Christ on St. Peter



The triple crown signifies the three types of temporal power—legislative, executive, and judicial—vested in the Pope

A red rope binds the keys